# APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — GEOGRAPHY

## Volume 5: Geography of Andhra Pradesh — Complete Handbook

Physical · Economic · Human · Fauna and Flora · Environmental geography of Andhra Pradesh, with current data (2025–26), 10 maps and 10 diagrams

**How to use this book:**
1. It follows the official syllabus headings: Group 1 Mains Paper II Part C (items 11–15: physical features, economic, social, fauna and flora, environmental geography) and Group 2 Prelims 'Geography of India and AP' (physical, economic and human geography). Volumes 1–4 cover world and India; this volume is **only Andhra Pradesh**.
2. Colours: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Gold** = latest data (verify) · **Orange** = Andhra Pradesh link (all regions) · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-test.
3. **Data honesty:** population figures are Census 2011 (the Census 2027 count is not yet available); economy, fish, fruit, power and port figures are 2024-25 or 2025-26 from the sources listed on the last page. Where a number changes quickly or sources differ, the book says 'about' or 'verify'.
4. Plan: 11 chapters in 11 days (~1.5 h each). Day 12: final self-test and Mock Test 5.

### Syllabus map: where each syllabus item is covered

| Syllabus item (Mains Paper II Part C / Group 2 Prelims) | Chapters |
|---|---|
| **11 Physical features and resources:** landforms, climate, soils, rivers, water, geology, rocks, minerals, clays, construction materials, reservoirs, dams, forests, mountains, hills, flora and fauna, vegetation | Ch 1–5, 7 |
| **12 Economic geography:** agriculture, livestock, forestry, fishery, quarrying, mining, household manufacturing, industries (agro, mineral, forest, fuel, manpower), trade, communication, road transport, storage | Ch 6–9 |
| **13 Social geography:** population distribution, habitations, density, age, sex, rural-urban, race, caste, tribe, religion, language, migration, education | Ch 1, 10 |
| **14 Fauna and floral geography:** wild animals, birds, reptiles, mammals, trees and plants | Ch 5 |
| **15 Environmental geography:** sustainable development, globalisation, temperature, humidity, cloud, winds, special weather, natural hazards, disaster management, impact assessment, pollution | Ch 4, 11 |
| **Group 2 Prelims:** general and physical geography of AP, natural hazards and disaster management; economic geography (resources, agriculture, industries, transport, tourism, trade); human geography (human development, demographics, urbanisation, migration, tribal, religious, linguistic groups) | Ch 1–11 |

Note: the official Group 2 notification should be checked for the final list; this volume is built from the published syllabus headings.

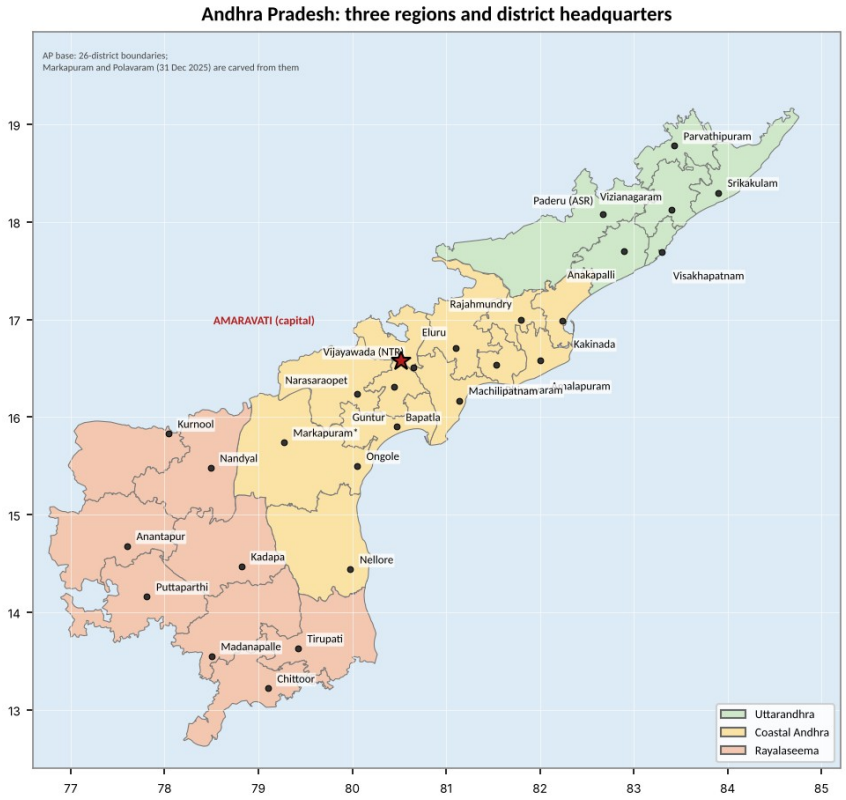
## CHAPTER 1 — Andhra Pradesh at a Glance: Location, Regions, Districts

*Where the state is, how it was made and how it is administered*

**IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)**

**Where:** south-east India, between about **12.6°N and 19.9°N** and **76.7°E and 84.8°E** — entirely south of the **Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N)**, so the whole state is **tropical**. **Area about 1.63 lakh km²** (about 1,62,970 km²; seventh-largest state by area). **Coastline about 974 km, second-longest in India** after Gujarat.
**Neighbours:** Odisha and Chhattisgarh (north), Telangana (north-west/west), Karnataka (west and south-west), Tamil Nadu (south), Bay of Bengal (east). **Yanam** (Puducherry's small enclave, ~30 km²) lies inside the Godavari delta in Kakinada district.
**Capital: Amaravati** (south bank of the Krishna, near Vijayawada–Guntur). Visakhapatnam is the largest city and the SCoR railway zone HQ.

## Map: three regions and district headquarters




## Three cultural-geographic regions

| Region | Where / what | Geographic character |
|---|---|---|
| **Uttarandhra** (North Andhra) | Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Parvathipuram Manyam, Alluri Sitharama Raju (ASR), Visakhapatnam, Anakapalli | Eastern Ghats hills and narrow coast; rivers Nagavali, Vamsadhara; cashew, coffee, bauxite; tribal areas; port-industrial Visakhapatnam |
| **Coastal Andhra** (Kosta) | East and West Godavari, Kakinada, Konaseema, Eluru, Polavaram, Krishna, NTR, Guntur, Palnadu, Bapatla, Prakasam, Markapuram, Nellore | Alluvial deltas of Godavari, Krishna, Penna; canal irrigation, rice bowl; aquaculture; cyclone-prone; ports |
| **Rayalaseema** | Kurnool, Nandyal, Anantapur, Sri Sathya Sai, YSR Kadapa, Annamayya, Tirupati, Chittoor | Deccan plateau, semi-arid rain shadow; black and red soils; groundnut, cotton; minerals; solar and wind; chronic drought; historic 'Ceded Districts' |

## How the state was formed (very important)

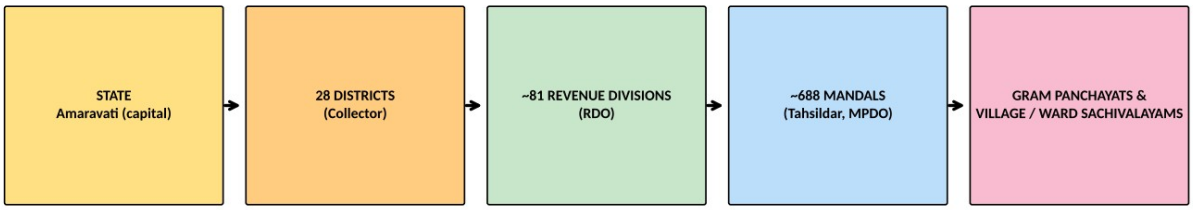
| Date | Event |
|---|---|
| 1 Oct 1953 | **Andhra State** carved from Madras State after **Potti Sriramulu's** fast unto death (1952); capital **Kurnool**; first CM **T. Prakasam** |
| 1 Nov 1956 | **Andhra Pradesh** formed by merging Andhra State with Telugu-speaking Telangana (**States Reorganisation Act 1956**); capital Hyderabad |
| 2 Jun 2014 | **AP Reorganisation Act 2014**: Telangana separated; Hyderabad common capital for up to 10 years; Polavaram declared a national project |
| 4 Apr 2022 | **13 → 26 districts** |
| 31 Dec 2025 | **Markapuram and Polavaram** added → **28 districts** |

## The 28 districts (headquarters)

| District | HQ | District | HQ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Srikakulam | Srikakulam | Palnadu | Narasaraopet |
| Vizianagaram | Vizianagaram | Bapatla | Bapatla |
| Parvathipuram Manyam | Parvathipuram | Prakasam | Ongole |
| Alluri Sitharama Raju | Paderu | **Markapuram (new)** | Markapuram |
| Visakhapatnam | Visakhapatnam | Sri Potti Sriramulu Nellore | Nellore |
| Anakapalli | Anakapalli | Tirupati | Tirupati |

| District | HQ | District | HQ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kakinada | Kakinada | Annamayya | Madanapalle |
| East Godavari | Rajamahendravaram | Chittoor | Chittoor |
| Dr. B. R. Ambedkar Konaseema | Amalapuram | YSR Kadapa | Kadapa |
| West Godavari | Bhimavaram | Anantapuramu | Anantapur |
| Eluru | Eluru | Sri Sathya Sai | Puttaparthi |
| **Polavaram (new)** | Rampachodavaram | Nandyal | Nandyal |
| Krishna | Machilipatnam | Kurnool | Kurnool |
| NTR | Vijayawada | Guntur | Guntur |

## Administrative set-up (diagram)




Counts as per the list of districts (28 from 31 Dec 2025); mandal and division totals change with reorganisation

**LATEST DATA (as of Oct 2026) — verify before the exam**

About **81 revenue divisions** and **688 mandals** statewide after the Dec 2025 reorganisation (counts per the state district list; they change with each reorganisation — check the latest government list).
**Largest by area:** YSR Kadapa (about 11,000+ km²; sources differ), Nellore, Anantapur, Markapuram, Nandyal. **Smallest:** Visakhapatnam (about 1,048 km²) after Anakapalli was split off.

**ANDHRA PRADESH LINK**

**Capitals and districts:** Madras (till 1953) → **Kurnool** (Andhra State 1953–56) → **Hyderabad** (1956–2014) → **Amaravati**. AP has **26 districts** in 3 regions: **North Andhra / Uttarandhra** (Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Parvathipuram Manyam, Visakhapatnam, Alluri Sitarama Raju, Anakapalli), **Coastal Andhra** (Kakinada, East Godavari, Konaseema, Eluru, West Godavari, NTR, Krishna, Guntur, Palnadu, Bapatla, Prakasam, SPSR Nellore) and **Rayalaseema** (Kurnool, Nandyal, Anantapur, Sri Sathya Sai, YSR Kadapa, Annamayya, Tirupati, Chittoor).

**EXAM TRAPS**

Capital of Andhra State (1953) = **Kurnool**; AP capital now = **Amaravati**.
Coastline **974 km = second longest** (Gujarat ~1,600 km is first).
**28 districts since 31 Dec 2025** (26 since 4 Apr 2022; 13 before).

**2-MINUTE REVISION**

12.6–19.9°N · 976 km… (974 km) coast, 2nd · 3 regions · 28 districts · Amaravati · 1953 → 1956 → 2014 → 2022 → 2025.

**CHECK YOURSELF**

Q. New districts of Dec 2025? **Markapuram, Polavaram.** Q. First capital of Andhra State? **Kurnool.**

# CHAPTER 2 — Geology and Relief

*The rocks beneath, the landforms above*

**IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)**

**Big picture:** AP has two very old landscapes: the **Deccan plateau (west)** and the **Eastern Ghats (hills in the middle and north)**, and a young **coastal plain (east)** built by rivers. Between them lies the **Cuddapah (Kadapa) basin**, a huge crescent-shaped bowl of old sedimentary rocks.
**Why it matters:** rocks decide **minerals** (Chapter 7), **soils** (Chapter 5), **groundwater** and where **tanks and dams** can be built.